City of Cambridge

RES 2026-133
FIRST IN COUNCIL
September 28, 2026

COUNCILLOR MCGOVERN

WHEREAS: The City Council was saddened to learn of the death of Haitham Mansour, a generous and devoted member of the Cambridge community whose decades of service to youth soccer touched the lives of thousands of young people and their families; and

WHEREAS: Haitham served as a committed Cambridge Youth Soccer coach for 25 years, during which time he coached more than 2,000 Cambridge children and gave more than 4,000 hours of his time to teaching and supporting young players; and

WHEREAS: Haitham’s dedication was evident week after week, as he regularly managed four sessions for different age groups, arriving at Russell Field as early as 7:30 am to set up goals and remaining until 3 pm to pack up the equipment at the end of the day; and

WHEREAS: Haitham's contribution to Cambridge Youth Soccer extended far beyond the players he coached, as he trained, mentored, and nurtured many CYS coaches over the years, including his son Tariq, who continues his father's legacy as a CYS coach; and

WHEREAS: Through his coaching, Haitham sought not only to develop young soccer players, but to instill in them self-belief, teamwork, generosity of spirit, and mutual respect, values that remained with the many young people fortunate enough to learn from him; and

WHEREAS: Haitham was also a familiar and beloved presence on the fields of Danehy Park for more than 30 years, where he was the founder and enduring symbol of an over-the-hill soccer group that brought together players from many countries and cultures through a shared love of the game; and

WHEREAS: On the field, Haitham was known as a notoriously difficult player to tackle, an unselfish attacker, and a talented goal scorer who could find the net with his head or either foot, earning the respect and affection of generations of teammates and opponents; and

WHEREAS: Even while facing the tremendous challenge of cancer, Haitham continued to think of others, establishing an enduring FOCRLS soccer sponsorship for Cambridge Youth Soccer to support deserving young people in pursuing opportunities to play soccer at the college level; and

WHEREAS: Haitham also left his mark throughout Cambridge through his professional work as a painter and decorator, bringing his skill, care, and craftsmanship to many homes across the city; and

WHEREAS: Haitham will be remembered for his courage, friendship, generosity, respect for others, and deep sense of fraternity, and his spirit will live on in the countless young people, coaches, teammates, friends, and families whose lives were enriched by knowing him; now therefore be it

RESOLVED: That the City Council go on record honoring the life and memory of Haitham Mansour and expressing its deepest condolences to his family, friends, teammates, fellow coaches, and the many members of the Cambridge community who knew and loved him; and be it further

RESOLVED: That the City Clerk be and hereby is requested to forward a suitably engrossed copy of this resolution to the family of Haitham Mansour on behalf of the entire City Council.

A true copy;

ATTEST:- Paula M Crane

Paula M. Crane,
Interim City Clerk

City of Cambridge

Resolution on the death of Haitham Mansour.